

vs Calibration Certificate

Calibration cert.

Pays confidence width forever (worst-case)



Ledger (ours)

Pays only realised loss on executed actions



Inputs

User Query stream q_t
Arrives sequentially

Evidence contract α
Risk rate $(0, 1]$

Decline price $c_{\perp}$
Cost of handoff (decline option)

Plan catalogue $\mathcal{P}$
Plans with cost & empirical risk

Plan p_1 cost $\hat{c}_1$ risk $\hat{r}_1$

...

Plan p_m cost $\hat{c}_m$ risk $\hat{r}_m$

Decline $\perp$ cost $c_{\perp}$ risk 0



Ledger-Gated Controller

1 Ledger Gate

$$B_t = \alpha t - V_t$$

Risk budget (wealth)
at time t

Reserve
 $1 - \alpha$

Gate Status

OPEN
 $(B_t > 0)$

CLOSED
 $(B_t \leq 0)$

2 Optimistic Action LP

Choose a mixed action over plans $\mathcal{P}$ plus decline $\perp$

Decision variable w

p_1 p_2 ... p_m $\perp$ (decline)
 w_1 w_2 ... w_m $w_{\perp}$

Optimise for best (cost, risk) trade-off under contract α

LP: minimize $\sum_{i=1}^m w_i \hat{c}_i + w_{\perp} c_{\perp}$ s.t. $\sum_{i=1}^m w_i \hat{r}_i \leq \alpha$, $\sum_{i=1}^m w_i + w_{\perp} = 1$, $w_i \geq 0$

Basic LP over $m + 1$ actions $\Rightarrow$ extreme-point solution has ≤ 2 nonzero supports.

Sample action
 $a_t \sim w$



3 Estimate & Audit

Online estimates

$\hat{c}_t(p)$ $\hat{r}_t(p)$
(cost) (risk)

Updated from observed outcomes

Audit label

$$\ell_t = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if realised loss} > 0 \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Loss L_t from execution or decline

Accounting rule

IPW (unbiased) ☒
vs.
Worst-case (conservative) ☐

Ledger update

$$V_{t+1} = V_t + \widehat{\text{loss}}_t$$

$$B_{t+1} = \alpha(t+1) - V_{t+1}$$



Outputs & Guarantees

Served answer OR human handoff
(decline $\perp$)



Pathwise contract

$$V_t \leq \alpha t$$

for all t (a.s.)



Cost near offline OPT

$$\leq (1.27 - 1.75) \times \text{offline optimal cost}$$



Microsecond overhead
vs. LLM seconds

1 Arrive
Query q_t arrives

2 Gate test
Check B_t (open/closed)

3 Optimise/Decline
Solve LP, sample $a_t \sim w$

4 Execute
Run plan p or decline $\perp$

5 Audit
Observe loss L_t , compute ℓ_t , update estimates

6 Update ledger
Update V_{t+1} , B_{t+1}

$\rightarrow$ next $t \dots$

Repeat for $t = 1, 2, \dots$